

Agriculture: Strawberry Pest Management Guidelines

Preplant

This year-round IPM program covers the major pests of strawberry fruit-production fields in California. Pest management activities for strawberry nurseries are discussed only as they impact pest problems in the field.

About Preplant

- [Mitigate pesticide effects\(/agriculture/strawberry/Pesticide-application-checklist/\)](#) on air and water quality.

Work with the nursery to obtain [transplants\(/agriculture/strawberry/Handling-Strawberry-Transplants/\)](#) of the desired [cultivar\(/agriculture/strawberry/Characteristics-of-Public-Strawberry-Cultivars-Commonly-Grown-in-California/\)](#) and certification level.

Survey previous crop and adjacent areas

- [Weeds\(/PMG/C734/m734pcweedsurvey.html\)](#): [keep records\(/PMG/C734/strawberry-weedsurvey.pdf\)](#) (PDF)
- [Lygus bug host plants\(/agriculture/strawberry/Lygus-Bug/#MONITORING\)](#)
- [Whiteflies\(/agriculture/strawberry/Whiteflies/\)](#)
- [Vertebrate pests\(/PMG/C734/m734lpvertsigs.html\)](#)

Review the [cropping history\(/agriculture/strawberry/Field-Selection/#CROP\)](#) of the field.

Analyze soil for nutrients and salts; consider an application of slow-release fertilizer.

Consider analyzing irrigation water for salinity and nitrogen content.

Consider soil treatments for soilborne pests and weeds.

- [Soil fumigation\(/agriculture/strawberry/drip-fumigation/\)](#) (broadcast or drip applied)
- [Soil solarization\(http://vric.ucdavis.edu/pdf/soil_solarization.pdf\)](#) (PDF) (only in non-coastal, warmer regions)
- Possible [alternative methods\(/agriculture/strawberry/Non-Fumigant-Alternatives-for-Soil-Disinfestation/\)](#) such as anaerobic soil disinfestation or steam treatments

[Prepare the field\(/agriculture/strawberry/Field-Preparation/\)](#) by making sure it is properly graded with good drainage.

[Shape beds\(/agriculture/strawberry/Field-Preparation/#FORM\)](#) to minimize water retention on bed tops.

Consider visiting the [transplant nursery\(/agriculture/strawberry/Handling-Strawberry-Transplants/\)](#) in the last month of the propagation cycle (before it gets cold) to evaluate nursery fields for:

- [Pest and pathogen problems\(/PMG/C734/m734rpnursery.html\)](#) that may be carried on transplants:

Invertebrates

- Spider mites
- Cyclamen mite

Diseases

- Angular leaf spot
- Anthracnose
- Phytophthora
- Powdery mildew
- Uniformity in planting, indicating possible disease or plant quality issues
- Pesticide usage

Apply herbicides, if needed, before applying mulch.

Apply [plastic mulch\(/agriculture/strawberry/Field-Preparation/#POLY\)](#) appropriate to your needs for:

- [Weed control\(/agriculture/strawberry/Integrated-Weed-Management/#MULCH\)](#)
 - Managing soil temperature
 - Controlling plant size
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